

HR KNOWLEDGE ARCHITECTURE & TAXONOMY

Enterprise HR Knowledge Structure for Self-Service, Search & AI

Document Type: Knowledge Architecture & Taxonomy Framework

Knowledge Domain: Human Resources / Employee Services

Audience: Employees · Managers · HR Teams · HR Service Owners

Scope: Global HR Knowledge Environment

Status: Design Framework

Version: 1.0

Owner: HR Knowledge Management

Review Cycle: Annual Architecture Review + Ongoing Content Reviews

1. PURPOSE

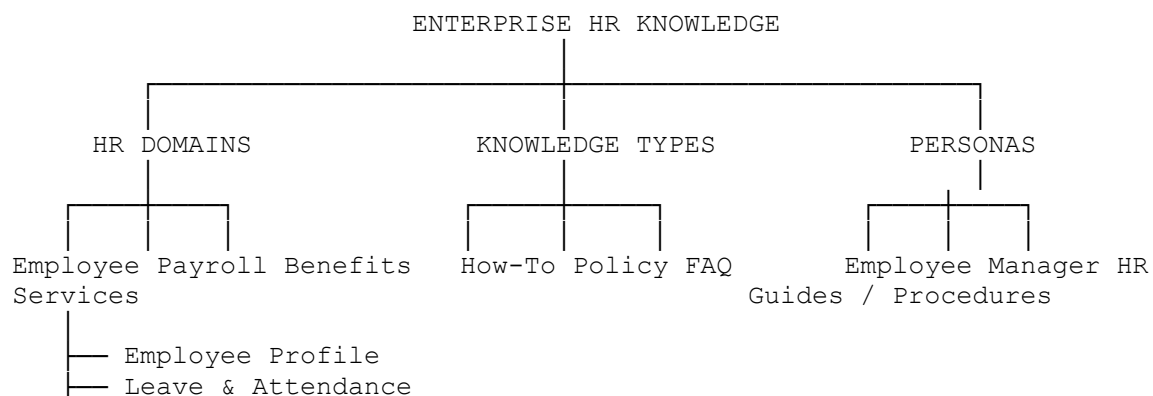
A well-designed HR knowledge environment should help employees **find the right information quickly, understand what they need to do, and complete common HR tasks without unnecessary assistance.**

This architecture establishes a consistent structure for organizing HR knowledge across **knowledge bases, portals, SharePoint repositories, ServiceNow, search experiences, virtual agents, and AI-powered knowledge solutions.**

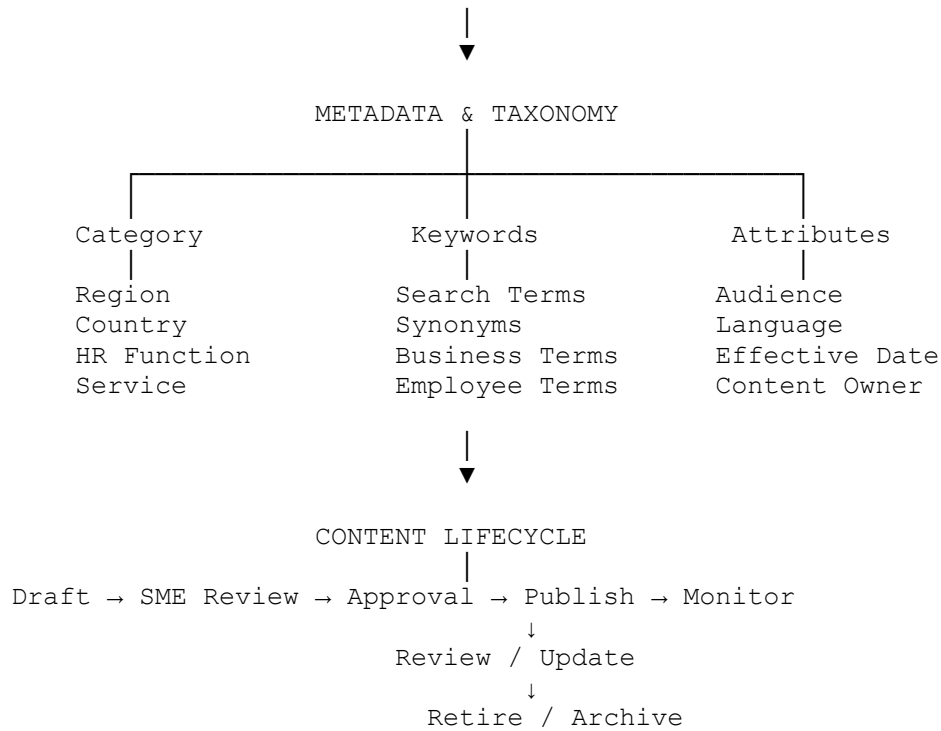
The framework connects five key elements:

Domain → Taxonomy → Metadata → Persona → Lifecycle & Ownership

2. ENTERPRISE HR KNOWLEDGE ARCHITECTURE



- Payroll & Compensation
- Benefits
- HR Policies
- Learning & Development
- Performance
- Career & Mobility
- HR Services & Support



3. HR DOMAIN STRUCTURE

The top-level HR domain provides the foundation for consistent navigation, search, reporting, and content ownership.

EMPLOYEE SERVICES

- Employee Profile
- Personal Information
- Employee Records
- HR Requests
- Employee Self-Service

LEAVE & ATTENDANCE

- Leave Policies
- Time & Attendance
- Holidays
- Absence Management
- Flexible Work

PAYROLL & COMPENSATION

- Payroll
- Salary & Compensation
- Payslips
- Tax Information
- Payroll Queries

BENEFITS

- Health & Wellness
- Insurance
- Retirement / Pension
- Allowances
- Employee Benefits

HR POLICIES

- Workplace Policies
- Code of Conduct
- Employment Policies
- Regional Policies
- Compliance

LEARNING & DEVELOPMENT

- Training
- Learning Programs
- Certifications
- Career Development
- Learning Platforms

PERFORMANCE & CAREER

- Performance Management
- Goal Setting
- Career Growth
- Internal Mobility
- Recognition

HR SERVICES & SUPPORT

- HR Service Requests
- Frequently Asked Questions
- Contact & Escalation
- HR Processes
- Employee Support

4. TAXONOMY MODEL

The taxonomy creates a consistent hierarchy for organizing and discovering HR content.

LEVEL 1 — BUSINESS DOMAIN

Human Resources



LEVEL 2 — HR FUNCTION

Employee Services · Payroll · Benefits · Leave · Learning · Performance · Policies



LEVEL 3 — SERVICE / TOPIC

Example:

Employee Services → Personal Information



LEVEL 4 — KNOWLEDGE TYPE

How-To · FAQ · Policy · Procedure · Guide · Reference



LEVEL 5 — CONTENT

Updating Your Personal Information

This structure allows the same knowledge model to work across **navigation, search, reporting, ServiceNow Knowledge, SharePoint, portals, and AI experiences.**

5. METADATA FRAMEWORK

Every knowledge article should carry consistent metadata to improve **findability, governance, personalization, and content analytics.**

Metadata	Purpose
Title	Clear employee-friendly article name

Metadata	Purpose
Domain	Primary HR business area
Category	Functional classification
Topic / Service	Specific HR subject
Content Type	FAQ, How-To, Policy, Guide, Procedure
Audience	Employee, Manager, HR, HR Service Agent
Region	Global, regional, or country-specific
Country	Applicable country or market
Language	Content language
Keywords	Search terms and business terminology
Synonyms	Alternative employee search terms
Content Owner	Accountable business owner
SME	Subject matter expert
Effective Date	Date content becomes applicable
Review Date	Next scheduled review
Version	Content version
Status	Draft, Published, Review, Retired

6. PERSONA-BASED KNOWLEDGE

The same HR information may need to be presented differently depending on **who is looking for it**.

EMPLOYEE

Need: Quick answers and task completion

Content emphasis:

- What do I need to know?
- What do I need to do?
- Where do I complete the task?
- What happens next?

MANAGER

Need: Guidance for managing employee-related activities

Content emphasis:

- Manager responsibilities
- Approval steps
- Policy guidance

- Escalation paths
- Manager-specific actions

HR / SERVICE AGENT

Need: Detailed process and resolution information

Content emphasis:

- Process documentation
- Case handling
- Exceptions
- Troubleshooting
- Escalation procedures

HR CONTENT OWNER / SME

Need: Content governance and maintenance

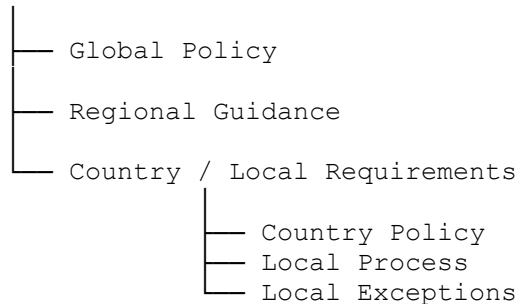
Content emphasis:

- Ownership
- Review dates
- Policy changes
- Version control
- Content quality

7. GLOBAL, REGIONAL & LOCAL CONTENT MODEL

A global HR environment requires a clear way to manage policy differences without creating duplicate or conflicting content.

GLOBAL HR KNOWLEDGE



Governance principle

Global content establishes the common standard.

Regional and local content provides approved variations where required.

Content should clearly identify its applicable **region, country, employee population, and effective date.**

8. CONTENT OWNERSHIP MODEL

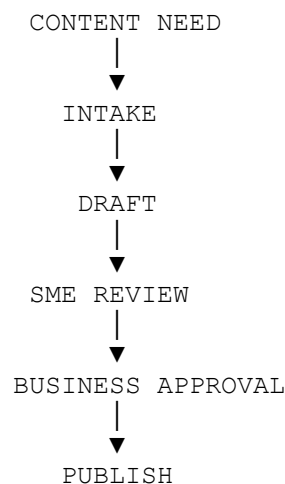
Clear ownership prevents outdated, duplicated, or conflicting information.

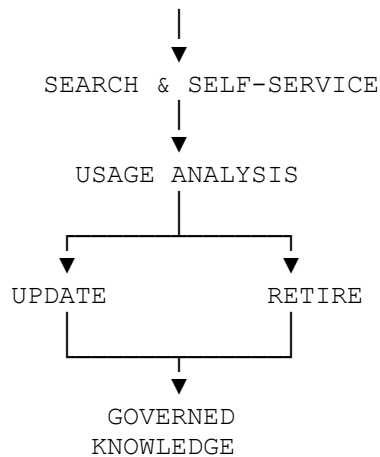
Role	Responsibility
Knowledge Management	Architecture, taxonomy, standards, governance
Content Owner	Business accountability and content accuracy
SME	Subject expertise and validation
HR Service Owner	Process and service alignment
HR Technology / ServiceNow Owner	Platform and technical alignment
Communications	Employee communication and messaging
Regional / Local HR	Local policy and regulatory variations

Ownership principle

Every published article should have an accountable owner, defined review date, and identified SME.

9. KNOWLEDGE CONTENT LIFECYCLE





Lifecycle Controls

- Defined content owner
- SME validation
- Approval before publication
- Version control
- Review and renewal dates
- Duplicate-content checks
- Usage and search analysis
- Retirement of obsolete content
- Audit trail where required

10. KNOWLEDGE QUALITY PRINCIPLES

CLEAR

Use plain language and employee-friendly terminology.

SEARCHABLE

Use meaningful titles, keywords, synonyms, categories, and metadata.

ACTIONABLE

Tell employees exactly what they need to do.

CONSISTENT

Apply common templates, terminology, taxonomy, and formatting.

TRUSTED

Identify ownership, review dates, source information, and approval.

CURRENT

Monitor content freshness and retire outdated information.

PERSONA-RELEVANT

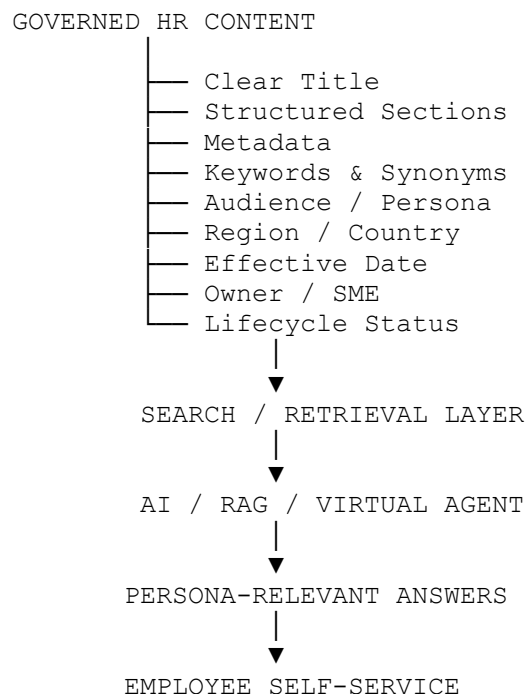
Present information according to the employee's role and context.

AI-READY

Structure knowledge so that enterprise search, virtual agents, chatbots, and AI/RAG solutions can retrieve and use trusted information effectively.

11. AI & RAG-READY KNOWLEDGE STRUCTURE

Modern HR knowledge should be structured not only for human readers but also for **search and AI-powered experiences**.



AI-readiness principles

Structure before scale

Well-structured knowledge creates a stronger foundation for AI retrieval.

Governance before generation

AI experiences should rely on trusted, approved, and current enterprise knowledge.

Context matters

Persona, geography, policy applicability, and effective dates help deliver relevant answers.

Traceability matters

Knowledge should remain connected to its source, owner, and lifecycle information.

12. KNOWLEDGE ARCHITECTURE ACROSS ENTERPRISE PLATFORMS

The same governed knowledge model can support multiple employee-facing and operational platforms.

Platform / Channel	Knowledge Role
ServiceNow Knowledge	HR self-service, case deflection, agent support
Employee Portal	Employee-facing discovery and task completion
SharePoint	Enterprise document and knowledge repository
Search	Cross-repository knowledge discovery
Virtual Agent / Chatbot	Conversational self-service
AI / RAG	Contextual knowledge retrieval and response
HR Communications	Targeted employee messaging

Architecture Principle

One governed knowledge foundation → multiple employee experiences.

13. CONTENT GAP & DUPLICATION MANAGEMENT

Knowledge architecture also provides a framework for identifying content problems.

COMMON CONTENT ISSUES

Duplicate

Multiple articles answer the same employee question.

Fragmented

Information is distributed across different repositories.

Outdated

Content no longer reflects the current process or policy.

Unowned

No accountable business owner is identified.

Hard to Find

Content exists but lacks appropriate metadata or search terms.

Conflicting

Different sources provide inconsistent guidance.

IMPROVEMENT APPROACH

Discover → Assess → Harmonize → Govern → Monitor

14. SUCCESS MEASURES

The effectiveness of a knowledge architecture should be measurable.

CONTENT HEALTH

- Content freshness
- Review compliance
- Percentage of content with owners
- Percentage of content with complete metadata
- Duplicate / obsolete content reduction

SEARCH & DISCOVERY

- Search success rate
- Zero-result searches
- Top search queries
- Search refinement patterns
- Content findability

SELF-SERVICE

- Case deflection
- Knowledge article usage
- Virtual-agent resolution
- Repeat inquiries
- Employee self-service adoption

EXPERIENCE

- Employee feedback
 - Knowledge satisfaction
 - Task completion
 - Time to find information
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15. GOVERNANCE SUMMARY

A sustainable HR knowledge environment requires **structure, ownership, governance, and continuous improvement**.

MY KNOWLEDGE ARCHITECTURE APPROACH

1. STRUCTURE

Create a logical HR domain and taxonomy model.

2. CLASSIFY

Apply consistent metadata, keywords, content types, and audience attributes.

3. GOVERN

Establish ownership, review, approval, publishing, and retirement controls.

4. PERSONALIZE

Design knowledge around employee, manager, HR, and regional needs.

5. CONNECT

Make knowledge usable across ServiceNow, SharePoint, portals, search, and AI experiences.

6. MEASURE

Use analytics, search behavior, feedback, and service trends to continuously improve the knowledge ecosystem.

PORTFOLIO NOTE

What this demonstrates

This artifact demonstrates my approach to **enterprise knowledge architecture and taxonomy**, with a focus on creating a consistent foundation for **HR self-service, content governance, search, analytics, and AI-enabled knowledge experiences**.

It brings together **HR domain structures, taxonomy, metadata, personas, global/local content models, ownership, lifecycle governance, content quality, and AI/RAG readiness** into a single knowledge framework.

The objective is simple:

Make trusted HR knowledge easy to find, easy to understand, easy to maintain, and ready for the next generation of employee experiences.